

VICE PRES: The tension between slowing down for safety and speeding up for strategic competitiveness.

NAJAH: Exactly. That's – that's actually very nicely put.

SEC. OF STATE: Madam Chair, let me fill everyone in a bit. A few months ago, OpenBrain's Agent-4 model had a bit of a bug. Started to behave in a less aligned way than anybody would have liked. Nothing to worry about, exactly, but we in the White House got wind of it and we thought we'd better have a talk with OpenBrain. Hence this committee.

STOSSEN: Yes. A bit of a bug. Ha.

The VICE PRESIDENT covers his mic and speaks directly to the SECRETARY OF STATE.

VICE PRES: Wait – you know about this? You were in the loop?

The SECRETARY OF STATE covers his own mic and replies to the VICE PRESIDENT.

SEC. OF STATE: I knew the broad strokes. Just enough so I could advise the President.

VICE PRES: The President knew about this?

SEC. OF STATE: Of course.

VICE PRES: For Pete's sake.

NAJAH: The President okayed our switch to Neuralese. And it is helping, we think. But we still want to emphasize that this nationalization initiative, this partial nationalization of key sectors, is almost certainly going to be necessary to maintaining our lead. Our A.I. supremacy, such as it is.

GREUNE: Sure. A partial nationalization of key sectors. Anything else we can do for you while we're at it? You want a back rub or something? You want us to wash your car?

NAJAH: Well –

GREUNE: Oh, right. There *is* more. You want us to station troops around your data centers. You want us to mobilize troops on our own soil.

NAJAH: We don't –

GREUNE: Mr. Najah, you've been addressing this committee for just a few minutes, and already you've shown yourself untrustworthy, interested, and in my opinion very likely corrupt.